

| By Damayanti Datta |

Ajay Bijli gives his body the same meticulous attention he does to his cinema chain, PVR. His days start with a one-hour run and pack in strenuous gym regimes: cardio, weights, lat pulls, dips and chins. Diet-savvy, he stays off sweets, fried food and white carbs. A regular at all city runs in Delhi, Bijli might be a well-known fitness enthusiast, but he is not alone. In Bangalore, Porus Irani zips

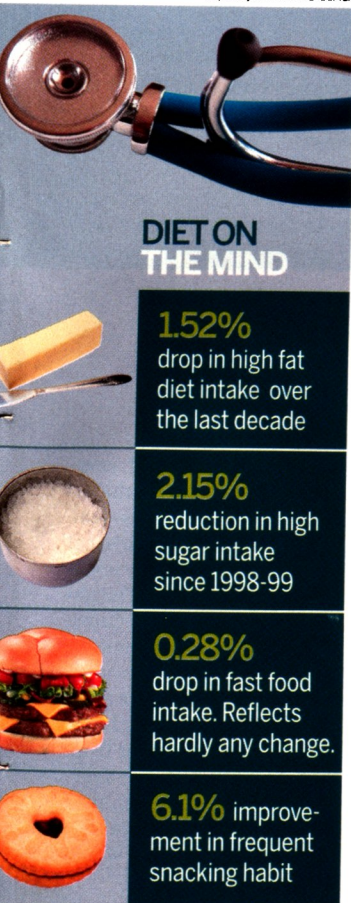
off to the gym in between managing his 5,500-strong facility firm, Handiman. In Kolkata, industrialist Karan Paul pumps iron in his glass-and-wood garden gym. In Mumbai, Rohit Narang, the Narang Group boss, swears by yoga. Chennai's R. Chandrasekaran, the top man at

Cognizant, jogs whenever he can squeeze in some miles. Just a few faces of India's growing tribe of health-conscious business leaders.

Corporate "fat cats" are supposed to be substantial people, who throw their weight around, literally. Even a decade back, the material status of business bigwigs used to be trumpeted in their girth. But with the focus of healthcare shifting away from risk toward prevention in the 2000s, silhouettes are changing. The physical ideal of the executive with a portly profile is giving way to a lean, mean and hungry look in the corridors of power. Corporate warriors of the New Economy are going about town fit and trim, counting calories at power lunches, squeezing in speedy workouts in between plane rides and meeting up with clients at chilled-out spas. Work might be worship, but fitness is the new religion. And right-minded executives are on the long-overdue road to good health.

Here's a study that puts numbers to the obsession with vigour in the executive ranks. The figures, culled out from health check-ups done at Apollo Hospitals, offer a rare insight into how healthy living has become de rigueur in the corporate rank and file over a decade. With a huge sample size, the study compares the health profile of 2.29 lakh employees from 581 corporates across 32 cities in 2008-09 with that of 15,000 executives of 100 organisations across six metros in 1998-99, when Apollo Hospitals compiled the health status of corporate

Graphics by MADHU MANGAL SINGH



Khane mein kya hai?



CHOLESTEROL-FREE | NO HYDROGENATED FATS

NO TRANS FATS | LOW IN SATURATED FATS

RICH IN MUFA & PUFA | VITAMIN A, D & E